

Module 10: Migration, Labor, and the Economy

Service Learning Project

Working Together: Supporting a Worker Center or Migrant Livelihood Program

Overview

Support a worker center, financial-inclusion nonprofit, or immigrant entrepreneurship program, and co-produce a livelihood resource that responds to a need the partner identifies.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe migrant labor roles in the local economy (UG 1)
- Identify economic contributions concretely (UG 2)
- Explain challenges migrant workers face (UG 3)
- Recognize exploitation risks and protections (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Worker centers and wage-theft clinics
- Immigrant entrepreneurship incubators and microloan programs
- Financial literacy nonprofits serving newcomers
- Farmworker or domestic worker advocacy organizations

Project steps

1. Complete partner orientation; learn what the partner sees as the priority need.
2. Serve directly: workshop logistics, ESL-for-work practice, childcare during trainings, outreach material distribution.
3. Co-produce one resource the partner requests: know-your-rights one-pager, small-business resource guide, banking-access explainer (partner reviews everything).
4. Learn the local labor market context: which sectors depend on migrant labor and what risks workers report.
5. Deliver the resource and gather partner feedback.
6. Reflection: connect what you saw to module debates on labor, contribution, and exploitation.

Deliverables

- Co-produced livelihood resource (partner keeps, partner-approved)
- Service log
- 3-page reflection on labor and economy themes

Time commitment

15 hours.

Ethics requirements

Students never collect immigration status or wage information; all outreach materials are partner-approved.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Service reliability and partner feedback 30%	Exceptional professionalism: service reliability and partner feedback is confirmed by strong partner or site feedback; the student was consistently prepared, dependable, and left the partner concretely better off.	Solid professionalism: service reliability and partner feedback is confirmed by positive partner feedback; commitments were met with only minor scheduling or preparation issues.	Inconsistent professionalism: service reliability and partner feedback is partially met — missed sessions, uneven preparation, or partner feedback indicating the student required significant management.	Inadequate professionalism: service reliability and partner feedback is not met; commitments were unmet or the partner's experience was negative.
Accuracy and usefulness of the resource 30%	The deliverable is excellent: accuracy and usefulness of the resource is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: accuracy and usefulness of the resource is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: accuracy and usefulness of the resource is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: accuracy and usefulness of the resource is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.
Understanding of local labor market dynamics 20%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: understanding of local labor market dynamics goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: understanding of local labor market dynamics is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: understanding of local labor market dynamics is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: understanding of local labor market dynamics is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Reflection quality 20%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: reflection quality shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: reflection quality shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: reflection quality is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: reflection quality shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.